Clinical Criteria for Medical Necessity, Acute Hospitalization & Surgical Interventions

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Official Healthcare & Insurance Knowledge Document

SECTION: Total Knee Arthroplasty TKA Clinical Criteria

Total knee replacement is medically necessary when: 1. Patient has severe Grade 3 or 4 Kellgren-Lawrence osteoarthritis verified on weight-bearing radiographs. 2. Debilitating joint pain Visual Analog Scale VAS score >= 7 significantly impairs daily living activities. 3. At least 6 months of documented conservative management including NSAIDs, physical therapy, weight reduction, and/or intra-articular injections has failed to provide relief.

SECTION: Acute Coronary Interventions & Spine Surgery Criteria

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Percutaneous coronary intervention PCI/stenting is medically necessary when coronary angiography demonstrates >= 70 percent stenosis in a major epicardial coronary artery with acute ischemic symptoms or positive stress test. Lumbar microdiscectomy is indicated for acute disc herniation with progressive motor deficit cauda equina syndrome, foot drop or radicular pain refractory to 6 weeks of conservative care.